PEER REVIEW HISTORY

BMJ Open publishes all reviews undertaken for accepted manuscripts. Reviewers are asked to complete a checklist review form (**http://bmjopen.bmj.com/site/about/resources/checklist.pdf**) and are provided with free text boxes to elaborate on their assessment. These free text comments are reproduced below.

ARTICLE DETAILS

TITLE (PROVISIONAL)	An investigation of cultural influences in survivors of pediatric cancer: a systematic review protocol
AUTHORS	Hou, Sharon H.J.; Schulte, Fiona

VERSION 1 – REVIEW

REVIEWER	Kaitlyn Fladeboe University of Washington
REVIEW RETURNED	30-May-2022

GENERAL COMMENTS	Thank you for the opportunity to review this manuscript. This paper describes the protocol for an ongoing systematic review that aims to describe extant studies investigating cultural influences in pediatric cancer survivorship and their influence on psychosocial outcomes. This review addresses a relevant and important topic in pediatric psychosocial oncology and has potential to address an important knowledge gap. However, I have some major concerns related to the manuscript's organization and degree of methodological detail. General comments: • Overall, the manuscript would benefit from improved organization, particularly within the Methods section. • A lack of consistent and clearly defined terminology limits clarity. • Important details regarding inclusion/analysis of qualitative studies are missing throughout the method descriptions. Detailed comments: Abstract 1. The description of study objectives (referred to as "outcomes") within the Abstract is unclear and needs additional detail. Please revise to align with the description of study objectives used later in the manuscript. I recommend replacing the term "outcome" with "objective" to improve clarity. 2. The authors state that a strength of the study is that it will, "address a gap in the current literature on the impact of culture on survivorship in pediatric cancer, including late effects of treatment, follow-up care, psychosocial outcomes, and quality of life". Based on the objectives and methods described, this systematic review will not include studies examining cultural influences on late effects, follow-up care, or quality of life - only on psychosocial outcomes. Thus, these should not be stated study strengths. Introduction 1. The introduction would benefit from more consistent description of the topics that will addressed within this review. Within the Introduction, the authors discuss knowledge gaps related to the

	influence of cultural factors on survivorship, engagement in treatment, and late effects, though the focus of this systematic review is limited to the influence of cultural factors on psychosocial outcomes. I would recommend narrowing the introduction to focus on current understanding and knowledge gaps related to cultural influences on survivors' psychosocial outcomes. Methods & Analyses 1. The organization of the Methods section needs improvement. For example, the information provided in the "participants and setting" subsection is part of the study selection eligibility criteria and should be described within that section. I recommend the authors restructure this section using only the following or similar subheadings: Literature Search/Inclusion Criteria, Study Selection, Data Abstraction, Quality Assessment. 2. Please describe if there were any eligibility criteria related study publication date. 3. As within the Abstract, I would recommend replacing the terms "primary outcome" and "secondary outcome" with "primary objective" and "secondary objective", respectively. 4. The authors state the qualitative and mixed-method studies may be included within their review, though do not provide criteria for how qualitative studies will be selected or how qualitative data will be extracted/summarized. In addition, the quality assessment indicators listed will also not apply to qualitative studies. Please add detail regarding data extraction, synthesis, and quality assessment for qualitative studies. 5. More detail is needed within the data analysis and synthesis description. Please include a description of how qualitative studies will be summarized within both study objectives, and for the second objective, provide more detail regarding the planned quantitative summary.

REVIEWER	Carol Ochoa University of Southern California
REVIEW RETURNED	02-Aug-2022

GENERAL COMMENTS	This article addresses an important and under-researched topic on the cultural influences on survivors of pediatric cancer. Below are some minor suggestions to help strengthen this protocol manuscript: Comments 1) The Background is very comprehensive with much important information. I suggest the authors provide a brief description of what encompasses psychosocial outcomes on Page 9, lines 33-34. 2) In the methods section, on Page 14, under the data extraction and management section, the authors should consider extracting the country in which the study was conducted as they mentioned this is something their systematic review will contribute to the literature.

VERSION 1 – AUTHOR RESPONSE

Reviewer 1
COMMENTS TO AUTHOR

Thank you for the opportunity to review this manuscript. This paper describes the protocol for an ongoing systematic review that aims to describe extant studies investigating cultural influences in pediatric cancer survivorship and their influence on psychosocial outcomes. This review addresses a

relevant and important topic in pediatric psychosocial oncology and has potential to address an important knowledge gap. However, I have some major concerns related to the manuscript's organization and degree of methodological detail.

GENERAL COMMENTS

• Overall, the manuscript would benefit from improved organization, particularly within the Methods section.
• A lack of consistent and clearly defined terminology limits clarity.
• Important details regarding inclusion/analysis of qualitative studies are missing throughout the method descriptions.

Author Response: Thank you for taking the time to review this work. We appreciate your feedback on our manuscript. First, we hope that our revisions under the Methods section helped to better organize the structure of our review. Specifically, we revised the subsections according to the suggestions from the reviewer. Second, we revised the terms we used throughout this manuscript to ensure consistency and clarity. Specifically, we replaced the terms "outcomes" with "objectives." We also provided a revised conceptualization of outcomes of survivors of childhood cancer, to include all clinical/medical, psychological, and social outcomes. Third, we have proposed a revision to our scope of the review in eliminating the inclusion of qualitative studies to strengthen the focus of our review.

We provide our detailed responses to each of your comments below.

ABSTRACT COMMENT 1:
1. The description of study objectives (referred to as "outcomes") within the Abstract is unclear and needs additional detail. Please revise to align with the description of study objectives used later in the manuscript. I recommend replacing the term "outcome" with "objective" to improve clarity.

Author Response: We appreciate your feedback on this. We have replaced the term "outcome" with "objective" to help improve clarity around our study objectives. Please see lines 21 to 23.

ABSTRACT COMMENT 2:
2. The authors state that a strength of the study is that it will, "address a gap in the current literature on the impact of culture on survivorship in pediatric cancer, including late effects of treatment, follow-up care, psychosocial outcomes, and quality of life". Based on the objectives and methods described, this systematic review will not include studies examining cultural influences on late effects, follow-up care, or quality of life - only on psychosocial outcomes. Thus, these should not be stated study strengths.

Author Response: We have removed the description of late effects, follow-up care, and quality of life from this description. Please see lines 44 and 45. Please note that we have revised the review objectives to better reflect the scope of our review (which would include late effects, follow-up care, and quality of life) but felt that this did not need to be elaborated under abstract/study strengths, as per feedback from editorial comments.

INTRODUCTION COMMENT 1
1. The introduction would benefit from more consistent description of the topics that will addressed within this review. Within the Introduction, the authors discuss knowledge gaps related to the influence of cultural factors on survivorship, engagement in treatment, and late effects, though the focus of this systematic review is limited to the influence of cultural factors on psychosocial outcomes. I would recommend narrowing the introduction to focus on current understanding and knowledge gaps related to cultural influences on survivors' psychosocial outcomes.

Author Response: Thank you for pointing out this discrepancy. As we have progressed with our systematic review, we have noted the proposed scope to be too narrow for the review. As such, we have revised our objectives to include psychosocial outcomes in addition to other, clinical outcomes – including (but not limited to) information on late effects, follow up/clinical care, and treatment outcomes. Please refer to lines 131 and 132 for these revisions which are also reflected in our search terms. The reported revision will be submitted to PROSPERO as well.

METHODS & ANALYSIS COMMENT 1
1. The organization of the Methods section needs improvement. For example, the information provided in the “participants and setting” subsection is part of the study selection eligibility criteria and should be described within that section. I recommend the authors restructure this section using only the following or similar subheadings: Literature Search/Inclusion Criteria, Study Selection, Data Abstraction, Quality Assessment.

Author Response: Thank you for this suggestion. The methods section has been re-labeled to align more closely with the suggestions provided above. Please refer to lines 132, 137, 170, 179, 188, and 202 for revisions.

METHODS & ANALYSIS COMMENT 2
2. Please describe if there were any eligibility criteria related study publication date.

Author Response: This is now reported on lines 153 – 154. No date filter was applied to ensure a comprehensive review of the studies conducted in this area to date.

METHODS & ANALYSIS COMMENT 3
3. As within the Abstract, I would recommend replacing the terms “primary outcome” and “secondary outcome” with “primary objective” and “secondary objective”, respectively.

Author Response: Thank you for this suggestion. We have updated the terms based on this reviewer’s suggestions that will hopefully help to clarify the focus of the review.

METHODS & ANALYSIS COMMENT 4
4. The authors state the qualitative and mixed-method studies may be included within their review, though do not provide criteria for how qualitative studies will be selected or how qualitative data will be extracted/summarized. In addition, the quality assessment indicators listed will also not apply to qualitative studies. Please add detail regarding data extraction, synthesis, and quality assessment for qualitative studies.

Author Response: Thank you for your feedback on this limitation of our work. In fact, as we progressed with our work we have revised our study methodology to include quantitative assessments only. This is now revised on line 142.

METHODS & ANALYSIS COMMENT 5
5. More detail is needed within the data analysis and synthesis description. Please include a description of how qualitative studies will be summarized within both study objectives, and for the second objective, provide more detail regarding the planned quantitative summary.

Author Response: As mentioned in the previous response, we have updated our systematic review protocol to eliminate qualitative studies for the purpose of ensuring a more focused assessment of existing studies.

Reviewer 2
GENERAL COMMENTS TO AUTHOR:
This article addresses an important and under-researched topic on the cultural influences on survivors of pediatric cancer. Below are some minor suggestions to help strengthen this protocol manuscript:

Author Response: Thank you for taking the time to review this work. We appreciate your feedback to our manuscript. We provide our response to each of your comment below.

COMMENT 1
1) The Background is very comprehensive with much important information. I suggest the authors provide a brief description of what encompasses psychosocial outcomes on Page 9, lines 33-34.

Author Response: Please refer to our description of our outcomes focused on lines 123 to 126.

COMMENT 2
2) In the methods section, on Page 14, under the data extraction and management section, the authors should consider extracting the country in which the study was conducted as they mentioned this is something their systematic review will contribute to the literature.

Author Response: Thank you for this suggestion. We agree that this would be relevant to the scope of this review. This has been added on line 202.

VERSION 2 – REVIEW

REVIEWER	Kaitlyn Fladeboe University of Washington
REVIEW RETURNED	10-Oct-2022

GENERAL COMMENTS	Thank you for the opportunity to re-review this systematic review study protocol addressing an important and under examined topic in pediatric psychosocial oncology. I appreciate the authors' thoughtful and comprehensive responses to my review and believe the manuscript is much improved. I have no additional concerns or comments.